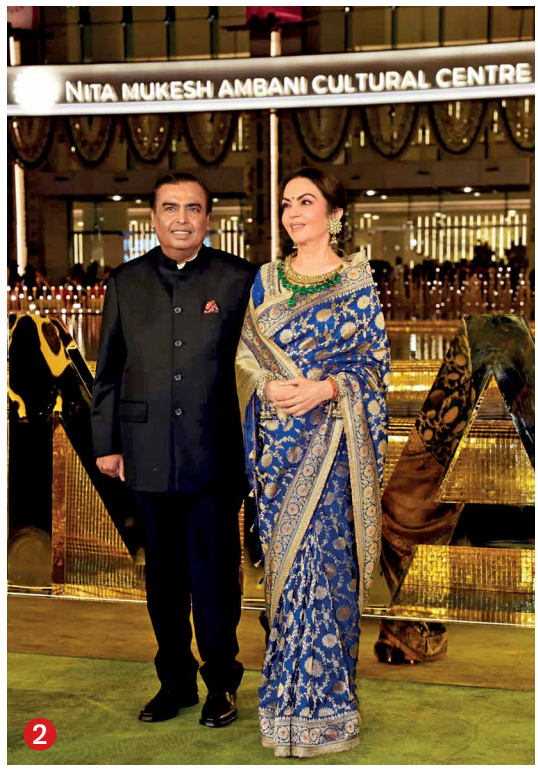


DESIGNED BY THE ATLANTA-BASED FIRM TVS DESIGN, THE NMACC AIMS TO TAKE INDIAN ART TO THE WORLD WHILE ALSO BRINGING THE BEST OF INTERNATIONAL ART TO INDIA



2

Photographs courtesy: NMACC



3

BATHED IN SPLENDOUR

1. The Grand Theatre

2. Mukesh and Nita Ambani at the launch of NMACC

3. The Centre's premises

250-seater Studio Theatre and 125-seater Cube—and a four-storeyed arts space called The Art House, the Centre is a huge boost to performing and visual arts in India.

Having a "world-class cultural centre" has been a passion project for Nita Ambani for years. Trained in Bharatanatyam and having done theatre at Mumbai's Narsee Monjee College, Ambani is a passionate arts enthusiast, inviting Indian classical dancers and musicians to her home, the iconic Antilia, to perform for international dignitaries and delegations as well as for many events of Reliance across India. "Culture weaves the threads of mutual understanding, tolerance and respect that knit communities and countries together," said Ambani, the founder and chairperson, at the launch of NMACC. "Culture brings hope and happiness to humanity. Therefore, as an artist, I hope this centre becomes a space that celebrates the arts, the artists, and the audience. A space where our people can feel proud of their heritage."

This is most evident in the theatrical production that NMACC has produced to mark its unveiling. *The Great Indian Musical: Civilisation to Nation* documents the history of India up until its independence. So enormous is its scale—it has over 350 artists, over 1,100 costumes, and a 55-piece live orchestra led by the Budapest Scoring Orchestra—that the dressing rooms at NMACC weren't enough to accommodate them. Instead, one of the three pavilions at the Jio World Convention Centre was converted into a backstage arena. Directed by Feroz Abbas Khan, best known for the 2016 musical *Mughal-e-Azam* and the film *Gandhi, My Father* (2007), *The Great Indian Musical* features choreography by National Award-winning Vaibhavi Merchant and Samir-Arsh Tanna as well as Mayuri Upadhya, costumes by Manish Malhotra, and music by Ajay-Atul. The demand for it was so massive that tickets—starting from Rs 400 and going up to Rs 25,000—for the show's three-week run at the Grand Theatre were nearly sold out as of April 5.

Another pavilion is home to a costume art exhibition titled *India in Fashion*, which highlights the influence of India's craft traditions on